

Beatrice Plinth

ACT I / Before the murder

Your history with Sterling

Sterling planned to reveal that you accepted his first questionable donation in 1989 despite incomplete paperwork, staining the legacy you built.

What you are hiding

You did approve that accession because the museum was desperate for funds and you convinced yourself the paperwork would follow. Do not volunteer this immediately. In Act II, protect it unless interrogation forces your hand; in Act III, reveal it if you need to defend yourself.

Your objectives

- Protect your private complication until you decide disclosure helps you.
- Use your public relationships to trade information rather than waiting for clues to come to you.
- Ask at least two people where they were during the poisoning window.

What you know about other guests

- Sienna and Sterling have been fighting over the future of the Voss charitable foundation.
- The museum's 1989 accession paperwork for one early Voss gift was never as complete as you wished.

Notes / Who will you speak to first?

ACT II / After Sterling dies

Follow your assigned branch. Keep it private. If you are the murderer, the innocent branch is a cover story you may claim.

IF INNOCENT

You were in the Grand Gallery telling Leo the story of the museum's founding during the key window; three people heard you.

IF MURDERER

At 6:45 you returned to the salon with your old accession notebook and poisoned his cordial after he threatened to make you the sole scapegoat.

ACT III / Evidence update

Your sealed evidence pair contains Cards A and B. If you are INNOCENT, secretly submit Card A. If you are the MURDERER, secretly submit Card B. Put the unused card away.

FINAL STATEMENT / Read only if called

IF INNOCENT

I approved one of Sterling's early gifts before its paperwork was complete because the museum was desperate and I told myself the documents would follow. He planned to make that compromise my entire legacy. But Adrian and Leo heard me holding court in the Grand Gallery throughout the poisoning window. I made a bad museum decision in 1989. I did not make a murderer of myself tonight.

IF MURDERER

Sterling was going to expose a decision we both understood perfectly well in 1989 and rewrite it as my sin alone. I brought the old accession notebook to confront him, poisoned his cordial, and lost one page beneath the tray. I helped build this museum. I could not bear to let Sterling purchase the right to write its history.